Physical examination points (CVS) 1

**Body Appearance and Facies**

■ The anasarca of congestive heart failure

■ The struggling, anguished, frightened, orthopneic, and diaphoretic look of pulmonary edema

■ The tall stature, long extremities (with arm span exceeding patient's height), and sparse subcutaneous fat of *Marfan's syndrome* (mitral valve prolapse, aortic dilation, and dissection)

■ The long extremities, kyphoscoliosis, and pectus carinatum of *homocystinuria* (arterial thrombosis)

■ The tall stature and long extremities of *Klinefelter's syndrome* (atrial or ventricular septal defects, patent ductus arteriosus, and even tetralogy of Fallot)

■ The tall stature and *thick* extremities of *acromegaly* (hypertension, cardiomyopathy, and conduction defects)

■ The short stature, webbed neck, low hairline, small chin, wide-set nipples, and sexual infantilism of *Turner's syndrome* (coarctation of the aorta and valvular pulmonic stenosis)

■ The dwarfism and polydactyly of *Ellis-van Creveld* syndrome (atrial septal defects and common atrium)

■ The morbid obesity and somnolence of *obstructive sleep apnea* (hypoventilation, pulmonary hypertension, and cor pulmonale)

■ The truncal obesity, thin extremities, moon face, and buffalo hump of hypertensive patients with *Cushing's syndrome*

■ The mesomorphic, overweight, balding, hairy, and tense middle-aged patient with coronary artery disease

■ The hammer toes and pes cavus of *Friedreich's ataxia* (hypertrophic cardiomyopathy, angina, and sick sinus syndrome)

■ The straight lower back of *ankylosing spondylitis* (aortic regurgitation and complete heart block)

**Gestures, Gait, and Stance**

■ The *Levine's sign* (clenched fist over the chest of patients with an acute myocardial infarction)

■ The preferential squatting of *tetralogy of Fallot*

■ The ataxic gait of *tertiary syphilis* (associated with aortic aneurysm and regurgitation)

■ The waddling gait, lumbar lordosis, and calves pseudohypertrophy of *Duchenne's* muscular dystrophy

(associated with hypertrophic cardiomyopathy and a pseudo infarction pattern on ECG)

**Face and Ears**

■ Pulsatility of the earlobes (tricuspid regurgitation)

■ Head bobbing (De Musset's and Lincoln's signs)

■ The round and chubby face of congenital pulmonary stenosis

■ The hypertelorism, pigmented moles, webbed neck, and low-set ears of *Turner's syndrome*

■ The round and chubby face of congenital valvular pulmonic stenosis

■ The elfin face (small chin, malformed teeth, wide-set eyes, patulous lips, baggy cheeks, blunt and upturned nose) of *congenital stenosis of the pulmonary arteries and supravalvular aortic stenosis*—often associated with hypercalcemia and mental retardation.

■ The unilateral lower facial weakness of infants with *cardiofacial syndrome*—this can be encountered in 5–10% of infants with congenital heart disease (usually ventricular septal defect); often noticeable only during crying.

■ The premature aging of *Werner's syndrome* and *progeria* (associated with premature coronary artery and systemic atherosclerotic disease)

■ The drooping eyelids, expressionless face, receding hairline, and bilateral cataracts of *Steinert's disease* (*myotonic dystrophy*, associated with conduction disorders, mitral valve prolapse)

■ The epicanthic fold, protruding tongue, small ears, short nose, and flat bridge of *Down syndrome* (endocardial cushion defects)

■ The dry and brittle hair, loss of lateral eyebrows, puffy eyelids, apathetic face, protruding tongue, thick and sallow skin of *myxedema* (associated with pericardial and coronary artery disease)

■ The macroglossia not only of *Down syndrome* and *myxedema*, but also of *amyloidosis* (linked to restrictive cardiomyopathy, congestive heart failure)

■ The paroxysmal facial and neck flushing of *carcinoid syndrome* (with pulmonic stenosis and tricuspid stenosis/regurgitation)

■ The saddle-shaped nose of *polychondritis* (associated with aortic aneurysm)

■ The tightening of skin and mouth, scattered telangiectasias, and hyperpigmentation/hypopigmentation of *scleroderma* (with pulmonary hypertension, pericarditis, and myocarditis)

■ The flushed cheeks and cyanotic lips of *mitral stenosis* (acrocyanosis)

■ The gargoylism of *Hurler's syndrome* (associated with mitral and/or aortic disease)

■ The short palpebral fissures, small upper lip, and hypoplastic mandible of *fetal alcohol syndrome* (associated with atrial or ventricular septal defects)

■ The diagonal earlobe crease as a (questionable) marker of coronary artery disease (*earlobe sign* [also known as Frank's sign])